Minutes of the Meeting of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax Held in the Council Chambers, Ajax Town Hall and Electronically on Monday, February 18, 2025

Alternative formats available upon request by contacting:
accessibility@ajax.ca *or 905-619-2529 ext. 3347*

Present:	Mayor	S. Collier
	Regional Councillors	M. Crawford
		S. Lee
		J. Dies
	Councillors	R. Tyler Morin
		N. Henry
		L. Bower

1. Call to Order & Acknowledgement of Traditional Treaty Lands

Mayor Collier called the meeting to order at 1:01 p.m. and acknowledged traditional treaty lands.

2. Disclosure of Pecuniary Interest

There were no disclosures of pecuniary interest.

3. Adoption of the Minutes

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: L. Bower

That the minutes of the Regular Meeting of Council held on January 20, 2025 be adopted.

CARRIED

4. Question Period

Mayor Collier invited questions on agenda items from those present.

5. Delegations, Presentations, and Public Meetings

5.1 Delegation: Black History Month – Black Health Week

The delegates were not in attendance.

5.2 Public Meeting: Official Plan Amendment Application OPA24-14 Zoning By-law Amendment Application Z18/24 1200 Salem Road North

Pursuant to section 284.3 of the Municipal Act, 2001

Maylor Collier noted that the proposed by-laws namely, Official Plan Amendment Application OPA24-A14 and Zoning By-law Amendment Application Z18/24 were brought forward under the authority of Section 284.3 of the Municipal Act, 2001.

Mayor Collier declared the meeting to be a public meeting and invited comments and questions from the public.

There being no questions or comments from the public, Mayor Collier closed the

public meeting.

Mayor Collier summarized the fundamental elements of the proposed by-laws.

Council Members asked questions related to the proposed development. Richard Domes, Principal Planner, Partner, Gagnon Walker Domes, Ltd., Mayor Collier, and Geoff Romanowski, Director of Planning & Development Services, responded to questions from Council Members.

5.3 **Delegation: Acceleration of the Rossland Road Widening**

Item 5.3 was withdrawn.

5.4 **Delegation: Acceleration of the Rossland Road Widening**

Marwan Zahra, Development Manager, Belmont Equity Partners, expressed support for agenda item 9.6 ‘Acceleration of the Rossland Road Widening’ and expressed concerns related to Clause 3 namely the proposed roadway alterations.

Council Members asked questions related to the delegation. M. Zahra responded to questions from Council Members.

6. Correspondence

Members separated correspondence Item 6.6 for discussion.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the balance of the report (Items 6.1, 6.2, 6.3, 6.4, 6.5, 6.7, 6.8, 6.9 and 6.10) dated February 18, 2025 containing Items of Correspondence be received for information.

CARRIED

Item 6.6

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: J. Dies

That Item 6.6, City of Pickering – Program of All-Inclusive Care for the Elderly (PACE), of the Correspondence Report be endorsed.

CARRIED

7. Reports

7.1 **Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report**

7.1.1 **Community Affairs & Planning Committee, February 3, 2025**

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Community Affairs & Planning Committee Report dated February 3, 2025 be adopted.

CARRIED

7.2 **General Government Committee Report**

7.2.1 **General Government Committee, February 10, 2025**

Council Members asked questions related to Item 6.1 of the General Government Committee Report - OES-2025-06: Ajax Community Centre (ACC) North Field

Community Park – Concept Plan Approval. Tim Field, Manager of Environmental Services, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: N. Henry

That the General Government Committee Report dated February 10, 2025, be adopted.

CARRIED

7.3 Summary of Advisory Committee Activities

None.

7.4 Departmental Reports

7.4.1. FIN-2025-04: Final Recommendation 2024 Development Charges Background Study and By-law

Moved by: J. Dies
Seconded by: N. Henry

1. That pursuant to section 10(1) of the Development Charges Act, 1997, the "Town of Ajax 2024 Development Charge Background Study" dated December 17, 2024, as amended, be approved.

2. That, based on the public input received by the Town, pursuant to Section 12(3) of the Development Charges Act, 1997 (the Act), Council determine no further public meeting is required.

3. That the Development Charges By-Law as set out in Appendix A (pg G-1) of Addendum to: Town of Ajax 2024 Development Charges Background Study, be approved.

CARRIED

8. Regional Councillors' Report

Regional Councillor Members provided updates from the Region related to Ajax Water Supply Plant Expansion and Harwood Avenue Pumping Station Upgrades, Durham Regional Police Services Board (DRPS) collective bargaining, DRPS board composition, DRPS 10-year capital plan, and 2024 key milestones from Durham Region Transit.

Council Members asked questions related to the reports. Mayor Collier and Regional Councillor Lee, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the Regional Councillors' Reports of February 18, 2025 be received for information.

CARRIED

9. Business Arising from Notice of Motion

9.1 Development of an Ajax Food Guide

Regional Councillor Lee and Regional Councillor Crawford introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. Regional Councillor Lee

and Kassandra Brownridge, Manager of Strategic Initiatives, responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Lee
Seconded by: M. Crawford

WHEREAS Ajax is proudly home to more than 250 restaurants, bakeries, breweries, cafes and other food and beverage providers;

AND WHEREAS the culinary offerings in Ajax are as diverse as our residents with influences from around the world;

AND WHEREAS the development of an Ajax Food Guide would help residents and visitors access the local food and beverage scene and discover new and exciting cuisines;

AND WHEREAS an Ajax Food Guide would further promote the retention and expansion of food and beverage businesses in Ajax;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

Public and Strategic Affairs be directed to:

1. Develop and distribute the 2025 Ajax Food Guide on ajax.ca, with limited hard copies to be available; and

2. Coordinate the design of the Ajax Food Guide with Communications and Engagement staff; and

3. Plan and host an event to launch the Guide and celebrate the Ajax restaurant community; and

4. Unbudgeted funds up to $10,000, be approved and funded from the capital contingency reserve.

CARRIED

9.2 **Impacts of the International Student Program Changes to Local Post Secondary Programs**

Mayor Collier introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: M. Crawford

WHEREAS the Town of Ajax recognizes the significant contributions of Durham College (DC) to our local economy and community through its diverse range of programs and skilled graduates;

AND WHEREAS the recent changes to the International Student Program (ISP) by Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) have negatively impacted post-secondary institutions in Ontario, including Durham College, by reducing international student study permits and limiting eligibility for Post-Graduation Work Permits (PGWP) to programs in fields of study identified as having national labour market shortages, irrespective of local labour market needs;

AND WHEREAS the Blue Ribbon Panel report commissioned by the provincial government highlighted the need for long-term, sustainable funding for the post-secondary sector, noting that Ontario’s colleges are funded at 44% of the national average, with tuition revenue first cut by 10% in 2019 and then frozen for the past six years;

AND WHEREAS the financial sustainability challenges faced by Ontario's post-secondary institutions have been exacerbated by significant wage and cost inflation, as well as the growing reliance on international enrolment;

AND WHEREAS DC has compiled a short list 34 programs not currently PGWP eligible to the IRCC list of fields of study (ATTACHMENT #1) which provide skilled graduates who are vital to growing our local economy, and in some cases, the College relies on international student enrolment in these programs to create financially viable cohorts for domestic students;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT

1. Ajax Council calls on the federal government to add the 34 programs listed in ATTACHMENT #1 and offered at DC to the IRCC list of fields of study; and

2. Ajax Council calls on the provincial government to enact the recommendation in the Blue Ribbon Panel report to provide long term, sustainable funding for the post-secondary sector; and

3. A copy of this resolution be sent to Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada Minister Marc Miller, the Ontario Ministry of Colleges and Universities, Regional Municipality of Durham Chair John Henry, and all lower tier Durham Region municipal Councils.

CARRIED

9.3 **Installation of All-Way Stop Signs**

Councillor Tyler Morin and Councillor Henry introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. Mayor Collier and G. Romanowski responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: N. Henry

WHEREAS there is consistent evidence of unsafe driving behavior, including frequent speeding, failure to yield, and aggressive driving patterns at the two-way stop-controlled intersection at Fletcher Avenue and Hibbard Drive, creating an urgent need to upgrade the intersection to an All-Way-Stop to enhance safety for all road users, including pedestrians, cyclists, and drivers;

AND WHEREAS due to driveway apron parking, residents are noting sightline-related issues at the following five (5) two-way stop-controlled intersections:

- Kerrison Drive West and Fletcher Avenue;
- Williamson Drive West and Hazeldine Drive/Tozer Crescent;
- Hollier Drive and Cantwell Crescent;
- Wicks Drive and Horton Street/Knowles Street;
- Finley Avenue and Burden Crescent;

AND WHEREAS the installation of All-Way-Stops at the above intersections will alleviate ongoing visibility concerns, reduce risks associated with potential liability issues in the event of incidents/accidents, and lessen the burden on transportation and parking enforcement staff while not impacting resident parking on driveway aprons;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Planning & Development Services and Operations & Environmental Services be directed to install All-Way-Stops at the following locations by end of May 2025:

    - Fletcher Avenue and Hibbard Drive;

- Kerrison Drive West and Fletcher Avenue;
- Williamson Drive West and Hazeldine Drive/Tozer Crescent;
- Hollier Drive and Cantwell Crescent;
- Wicks Drive and Horton Street/Knowles Street;
- Finley Avenue and Burden Crescent; and

2. Costs associated with this unbudgeted capital project be approved and funded from the capital contingency reserve.

CARRIED

9.4 Honouring Veterans with a Crosswalk Installation at Veteran's Point Gardens

Councillor Henry and Councillor Tyler Morin introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. Mayor Collier responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: N. Henry
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

WHEREAS the Town of Ajax has a proud military history, serving as the home of the largest shell filling plant in the British Commonwealth during World War II, was named in honour of the Royal Navy ship H.M.S. Ajax, and has celebrated veterans who served aboard the ship by naming local streets in their honour;

AND WHEREAS numerous communities throughout the province including Pickering, Bowmanville, Hamilton, Belleville, Petawawa, and Chatham, are introducing special crosswalks in recognition of our veterans;

AND WHEREAS installation of a crosswalk at Veteran's Point Garden would be an opportunity for the Town of Ajax to continue contributing to honouring veterans;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT

1. Operations and Environmental Services, with support from Public and Strategic Affairs and Transportation Services, be directed to work in consultation with Royal Canadian Legion Branch 322 to design and install a crosswalk at Veteran's Point by October 2025; and

2. $20,000 for this unbudgeted capital project be approved and funded from the capital contingency reserve; and

3. A copy of this motion be sent to Royal Canadian Legion Branch 322.

CARRIED

9.5 Response to 25% Tariff Threat from United States

Regional Councillor Crawford and Councillor Tyler Morin introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

WHEREAS the Town of Ajax has more than 75 businesses that export primarily to the United States, representing over 4000 employees locally;

AND WHEREAS United States President Donald Trump has committed to imposing a blanket 25% tariff on Canadian goods, which pose a serious threat to the entire Canadian economy;

AND WHEREAS the Town of Ajax's combined 2025 Capital and Operating Budget represents a purchasing power of over $50 million;

AND WHEREAS municipalities in Ontario are subject to obligations under international trade agreements, and federal legislation, such as the Comprehensive Economic and Trade Agreement (CETA), the Canada-United States-Mexico Agreement (CUSMA) and the Competition Act, which mandate certain procurement practices and ensure non-discriminatory access to procurement opportunities by foreign businesses in Canada;

AND WHEREAS the Business Supports & Engagement team has taken steps, including a resource hub on the Town's website and direct outreach to businesses, to ensure the Town is a vocal supporter of Team Canada by working closely with Invest Durham, Invest Ontario, and Invest in Canada to provide timely information and localized support for Ajax businesses in response to tariff threats and a potential trade war;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. Ajax Council fully endorse the actions and sentiments of Team Canada to protect Canadian consumers, support Canadian businesses, and mitigate the impact of a potential trade war; and

2. The Manager of Procurement be directed to investigate how the Town can prefer non-American companies when purchasing goods and services, particularly when valued less than $100,000 and, if deemed possible, present Council with a revised Procurement By-law for approval at the March 24, 2025, Meeting of Council; and

3. That the Town send a letter to the Minister of International Trade Diversification requesting amendments to the federal Competition Act to remove any barrier for municipalities preferring Canadian companies; and

4. That a copy of this motion be sent to:

    a. Prime Minister Justin Trudeau
    b. Premier Doug Ford
    c. Hon. Melanie Joly, Minister of Foreign Affairs
    d. Hon. Mary Ng, Minister of International Trade Diversification
    e. Hon. Vic Fedeli, Ontario Minister of Economic Development, Job Creation and Trade
    f. Hon. Mark Holland, MP for Ajax
    g. Patrice Barnes, MPP for Ajax
    h. Durham Regional Chair John Henry
    i. Alli Leetham, Executive Director of the Ajax-Pickering Board of Trade

CARRIED

9.6. **Acceleration of the Rossland Road Widening**

Mayor Collier and Councillor Henry introduced the motion and reviewed its contents.

Council Members asked questions related to the motion. T. Field responded to questions from Council Members.

Moved by: S. Collier
Seconded by: N. Henry

WHEREAS Rossland Road has experienced a dramatic and sustained increase in traffic volume due to rapid and ongoing urban development both within the Region and specifically in Ajax;

AND WHEREAS the design for the widening and urbanization of Rossland Road, extending from Westney Road to Lakeridge Road in Ajax, is currently in progress to address these growing transportation demands;

AND WHEREAS the construction of the road improvements for the subject project is scheduled in phases, with Phase 1 planned for the section from Salem Road to Lakeridge Road in 2026, and Phase 2 from Westney Road to Salem Road in 2028;

AND WHEREAS there are several proposed developments between Harwood Avenue and Salem Road which will further exacerbate traffic congestion in the area;

AND WHEREAS expanding the scope of Phase 1 to include the section from Harwood Avenue to Salem Road, originally planned for Phase 2, will alleviate congestion in both the short and long-term in this rapidly growing area;

NOW THEREFORE BE IT RESOLVED THAT:

1. The scope of Phase 1, including land acquisition and utility relocation work planned for 2025 and road works planned for 2026, be expanded to include all works associated with Phase 2 (Westney Road to Salem Road); and

2. That Council request that the Mayor identify all works as a single project in the 2026 Capital Budget; and

3. The design and construction include the necessary underground works to accommodate future traffic signals at Spitty Drive.

Motion to Refer

Moved By: S. Lee
Seconded by: L. Bower

That staff report back to Council at the March 2025 Council meeting on the cost implications of a Phase 1 approach vs. Phase 2 approach and impacts to the Development Charges schedule.

CARRIED

10. By-laws

Moved by: R. Tyler Morin
Seconded by: S. Lee

That By-law numbers 11-2025 to 12-2025 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED
on 1/3rd

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: N. Henry

That By-law numbers 13-2025 to 17-2025 be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

11. Notice of Motion

None.

12. New Business - Notices & Announcements

Council Members highlighted upcoming community events and matters of community interest.

Council Members requested an update from staff related to winter operations. T. Field, Nicole Cooper, Deputy Chief Administrative Officer, and Aaron Burridge, Fire Chief, responded to questions from Council Members.

13. Confirming By-Law

Moved by: L. Bower
Seconded by: N. Henry

That By-law number 18-2025 being a by-law to confirm the proceedings of the Council of the Corporation of the Town of Ajax at its regular meeting held on February 18, 2025, be read a first, second and third time and passed.

CARRIED

14. Adjournment

Moved by: M. Crawford
Seconded by: R. Tyler Morin

That the February 18, 2025 meeting of the Council of the Town of Ajax be adjourned (2:33 p.m.)

CARRIED

_____
Mayor and CEO

_____
Clerk